BUILD YOUR AI CEO — THE COMPLETE SETUP GUIDE

Install Your AI CEO's Brain

Move Your Personalized Files Into the OpenClaw Workspace

MODULE 4B — DOWNLOAD PACKET

Step-by-Step Student Setup Guide — Mac and Windows (WSL2)

What You'll Accomplish

In Module 1, you created and personalized the files that give your AI CEO its identity, personality, business knowledge, and operating instructions.

In this lesson, you'll install those files into OpenClaw's workspace.

By the end, you will have:

- Located your AI CEO's workspace folder.
- Backed up any starter files OpenClaw created during installation.
- Copied your personalized files into the correct location.
- Used Terminal to verify your filenames and file extensions.
- Confirmed that your AI CEO's files are ready for the next lesson.

Before You Start

Make sure you have:

- Completed the Node.js and OpenClaw installation in Video 4A.
- Completed the OpenClaw setup wizard.
- Saved your personalized Module 1 files in a folder on your Desktop.
- **Standard Course:** 15 files total — 14 Markdown files and 1 JSON file.
- **Starter Kit Upgrade:** 34 files total, including the standard course files.

How to Use Terminal Commands

Whenever you see a command in this guide:

1. Copy the entire command.
2. Open Terminal on your Mac or Ubuntu/WSL Terminal on Windows.
3. Paste the command.
4. Press Enter.
5. Wait for the result before continuing.

You don't need to memorize the commands!

Step 1 — Open Your AI CEO's Workspace

Your AI CEO's workspace is the folder where OpenClaw stores the files that help define how your AI CEO behaves and operates. Think of it as your AI CEO's office.

1. Find your workspace location

Open Terminal and run this command:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
openclaw config get agents.defaults.workspace
```

You may see a path similar to:

```
~/.openclaw/workspace
```

This is the standard OpenClaw workspace location. The `~` symbol simply means your computer's home folder.

> ***Important:*** *If OpenClaw shows a different workspace location, that's okay! Use the location configured for your installation. If OpenClaw reports that no workspace setting is explicitly configured, it may be using the standard default.*

2. Open the workspace folder

For Mac Users — If you're using the standard workspace location, run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
open "$HOME/.openclaw/workspace"
```

Your workspace should open in Finder.

For Windows Users (WSL2) — If you're using the standard workspace location, run in your Ubuntu/WSL Terminal:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
cd "$HOME/.openclaw/workspace" && explorer.exe .
```

Your workspace should open in Windows File Explorer.

> ***If the folder doesn't open:*** *Stop and check the workspace path before continuing. Do not create a second, unrelated workspace folder.*

Step 2 — Back Up Any Existing OpenClaw Files

When you installed OpenClaw, it may have automatically created some starter Markdown files. You might see files such as:

- `AGENTS.md`
- `SOUL.md`
- `IDENTITY.md`
- `USER.md`
- `TOOLS.md`
- `HEARTBEAT.md`

That's completely normal! These are starter files OpenClaw uses to help initialize a new AI agent. However, in Module 1, you already created personalized versions specifically for your AI CEO. We want to use your customized files while protecting anything important that OpenClaw may have created.

1. Check for existing files

Look inside the workspace folder you opened in Step 1. If you see files with the same names as your Module 1 files, you'll need to back them up before replacing them.

2. Create a backup folder

On your computer's Desktop, create a new folder named:

```
OpenClaw Starter Files Backup
```

Keep this folder **outside** your OpenClaw workspace.

3. Copy the existing starter files

Select the existing files that have the same names as your personalized Module 1 files. Copy them into your new backup folder. Do not delete the originals yet.

4. Check for important information

If you've already used OpenClaw to personalize your AI CEO or enter important information, review those existing files before replacing them. You don't want to accidentally lose something important.

> ***What about BOOTSTRAP.md?*** *You may also see a file called* `BOOTSTRAP.md`*. This is an OpenClaw first-run setup file — it is not one of your 15 standard course files. Leave* `BOOTSTRAP.md` *alone for now. We'll address the initial onboarding process during the First Contact lesson.*

You're done with Step 2! Your existing files are backed up.

Step 3 — Install Your Personalized AI CEO Files

Now it's time to install the files you created in Module 1!

1. Find your Module 1 files

Go to the folder on your Desktop where you saved your completed AI CEO `.md` files.

Your Six Core Files

- `SOUL.md`
- `IDENTITY.md`
- `USER.md`
- `MEMORY.md`
- `AGENTS.md`
- `HEARTBEAT.md`

Your Nine Operational Files

- `SAFETY_RULES.md`
- `EXECUTION_PROTOCOL.md`
- `BOARD_OF_DIRECTORS.md`
- `VENTURE_ENGINE.md`
- `PRD_TEMPLATE.md`

- `AGENT_HEALTH_SYSTEM.md`
- `SYSTEM_STARTUP.md`
- `ACTIVE_TASK.json`
- `TOOLS.md`

> ***Starter Kit Upgrade:*** *If you purchased the upgrade, you should have 34 files total. Use the complete file collection provided with your upgrade.*

2. Select your files

Select all 15 standard files (or all 34 Starter Kit files). Copy them.

3. Paste the files into your workspace

Return to the OpenClaw workspace folder you opened in Step 1. Paste your files directly into this folder.

> ***Important:*** *Do not paste the entire Desktop folder containing your files into the workspace. We want the actual files to sit directly inside the workspace, not inside another folder.*

4. Replace existing starter files if prompted

If your computer asks whether you want to replace files with the same names:

- Make sure you completed the backup in Step 2.
- Confirm the incoming files are your personalized Module 1 versions.
- Choose **Replace** for those matching files.
- Leave unrelated OpenClaw files and folders in place.

Step 4 — Verify Your Files Using Terminal

This is an important step! Sometimes when you create Markdown files using a text editor, your computer may accidentally save them with the wrong file extension.

For example, you might think you created `SOUL.md` — but your computer actually saved `SOUL.md.txt`. These are not the same thing! We need to make sure your Markdown files really end in `.md` and your task-tracking file ends in `.json`.

1. Navigate to your workspace

Run this command in Terminal:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
cd "$HOME/.openclaw/workspace"
```

If you have a custom workspace, use that folder's actual path instead. This command tells Terminal to work inside your AI CEO's workspace.

2. Display all the files in your workspace

Now run:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
ls -1
```

Terminal will display a list of the files and folders inside your workspace. Your standard course files should appear with names similar to these:

```
ACTIVE_TASK.json
AGENT_HEALTH_SYSTEM.md
AGENTS.md
BOARD_OF_DIRECTORS.md
EXECUTION_PROTOCOL.md
HEARTBEAT.md
IDENTITY.md
MEMORY.md
PRD_TEMPLATE.md
SAFETY_RULES.md
SOUL.md
SYSTEM_STARTUP.md
TOOLS.md
USER.md
VENTURE_ENGINE.md
```

You may see additional files or folders that OpenClaw created automatically. That's okay!

3. Check the file extensions

Look carefully at the end of each filename.

Your Markdown files should end in `.md`
Your task-tracking file should end in `.json`

Incorrect examples: `SOUL.md.txt` · `IDENTITY.txt` · `AGENTS.md.rtf` · `ACTIVE_TASK.json.txt`

Correct examples: `SOUL.md` · `IDENTITY.md` · `AGENTS.md` · `ACTIVE_TASK.json`

4. Automatically check all 15 standard filenames

Copy this entire command into Terminal and press Enter:

▷ TERMINAL COMMAND — COPY & PASTE INTO TERMINAL

```
for file in SOUL.md IDENTITY.md USER.md MEMORY.md AGENTS.md HEARTBEAT.md SAFETY_RULES.md
EXECUTION_PROTOCOL.md BOARD_OF_DIRECTORS.md VENTURE_ENGINE.md PRD_TEMPLATE.md
AGENT_HEALTH_SYSTEM.md SYSTEM_STARTUP.md ACTIVE_TASK.json TOOLS.md; do
  if [ -f "$file" ]; then
    echo "OK: $file"
  else
    echo "MISSING: $file"
  fi
done
```

Terminal will check each of your 15 standard course files.

- If a file exists with the correct name, you'll see: `OK: SOUL.md`
- If a file cannot be found under the correct name, you'll see: `MISSING: SOUL.md`

> ***Important:*** *A missing result doesn't necessarily mean the file is gone. It may simply have the wrong name or extension. This command checks filenames and whether the files exist — it does not check whether their contents are complete or correctly formatted.*
>
> ***Starter Kit Upgrade:*** *This command checks the 15 standard files. Your additional upgrade files must also be checked against the Starter Kit file list.*

Step 5 — Fix Any Incorrect File Extensions

If all your filenames are correct and nothing is missing, congratulations! You can skip to Step 6.

If you see a filename ending in `.txt` when it should end in `.md`, here's how to fix it.

Mac

1. Open your workspace in Finder.
2. Find the incorrectly named file.
3. Right-click the file and choose **Rename**.

4. Change the filename to the correct name (e.g. `SOUL.md.txt` → `SOUL.md`).
5. Press Enter.
6. If macOS asks whether you want to keep the old extension or use the new one, choose the option that uses `.md`.

Windows (WSL2)

1. Open the workspace in Windows File Explorer.
2. Select **View → Show → File name extensions** if extensions are hidden.
3. Find the incorrectly named file.
4. Right-click and choose **Rename**.
5. Change the filename to the correct name (e.g. `IDENTITY.md.txt` → `IDENTITY.md`).
6. Press Enter and confirm the extension change if prompted.

> ***Important:*** *Renaming a file changes its filename, not its actual contents. These files must contain plain text or Markdown, not a formatted Word or rich-text document.*

Verify your correction

Return to Terminal and run `ls -1` to confirm the corrected filename now appears. You can also rerun the automatic filename-checking command from Step 4.

Step 6 — Final Workspace Check

Before moving on, let's make sure everything is ready.

Your Checklist

- [ ] I opened the correct OpenClaw workspace.
- [ ] I backed up any existing starter files with matching names.
- [ ] I copied my personalized Module 1 files into the workspace.
- [ ] My files are directly inside the workspace, not inside an extra folder.
- [ ] I used Terminal to display my filenames.
- [ ] My 14 standard Markdown files end in `.md`.
- [ ] My standard task-tracking file ends in `.json`.
- [ ] I corrected any filenames ending incorrectly in `.txt`.
- [ ] I verified that all 15 standard filenames are present.
- [ ] If I purchased the Starter Kit Upgrade, I also verified my additional files.

Congratulations — You've Installed Your AI CEO's Brain!

Your personalized files are now in the OpenClaw workspace. These files provide the foundation for your AI CEO's identity, personality, business knowledge, and operating instructions.

One important thing to know: Some of your custom operational files are reference documents. Simply placing them in the workspace does not guarantee OpenClaw will read every one automatically. Your main operating instructions will help direct the AI CEO to consult them when needed.

Scheduled tasks, integrations, and automated reports will be configured separately.

Up Next — Module 4C: Connect Your AI CEO to Discord

In the next lesson, we'll invite your Discord bot into your server, connect it to OpenClaw, and add your Discord credentials and channel information.

You're one step closer to meeting your AI CEO!